

LOCATION

Norwegian Sea

Tromsø

Bodo

Trondheim

Bergen

Stavanger

SWEDEN

FINLAND

Fjords occur along much of the western coast of Norway, with the largest and deepest between Stavanger and Trondheim.

0 km 300
0 miles 300

CLIMATE

The climate is temperate and seasonal, but relatively mild owing to the influence of the Gulf Stream. Rain falls all year-round.

(Molde, Romsdale)

°F	°C	MM	IN
104	40	160	6 1/4
86	30	120	4 3/4
68	20	80	3 1/4
50	10	40	1 1/2
32	0	0	0

Jan Feb Mar Apr May Jun Jul Aug Sep Oct Nov Dec

Key — Average temperature — Rainfall

than 8,000 years old

DEEP, DARK REEFS

Lophelia pertusa is an unusual coral, able to live at depth in cold water. It grows exceptionally slowly, feeding on dead plankton that drifts down from the sunlit waters above. Norway's coast hosts the greatest known density of lophelia reefs in the world.

LOPHELIA CORAL

Gray seal

Halichoerus grypus



The gray seal is perfectly adapted to its cold-water environment. Up to 3 in (7.6 cm) of blubber gives this marine mammal excellent insulation, but it also diverts blood from the skin to vital organs. It hunts at depths of 200–985 ft (60–300 m), even in zero visibility, exhaling to collapse its lungs, then using its super-sensitive whiskers to track wakes left by sand eels and other prey.

↔ 6–8 ft (1.8–2.4 m)

⚖ 220–680 lb (100–310 kg)

⊗ Common

🐟 Sand eels, squid, octopus

🏠

N. Atlantic



◁ **SURFING ASHORE**

Found in large colonies, gray seals haul out on beaches, ice, and rocky outcrops to rest, breed, molt, and give birth.

Harbor porpoise

Phocoena phocoena

Harbor porpoises frequent coastal areas, particularly cold-water shallow bays, where they search for food along the sea floor. Although often confused with dolphins,

when viewed from a distance, porpoises have small dorsal fins, are more rotund, and lack a distinct beak. They also avoid boats, and seldom bow-ride.

↔ 4–7 ft (1.2–2.1 m)

⚖ 99–165 lb (45–75 kg)

⊗ Common

🐟 Fish, squid, octopus

🏠

N. Pacific, N. Atlantic, Black Sea



△ **LOUD EXHALER**

Due to the sneezelike sound made when they breathe through their blowholes, harbor porpoises were once known as “puffing pigs.”

tail has two partially separated flukes